

Cross-Domain Generalization Assessment for Object Detection Models: FID-Based Domain Shift Detection

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Abstract—Predicting the performance degradation of object detection models when deployed in novel environments remains a significant challenge. This paper introduces an automated post-training assessment pipeline for evaluating cross-domain generalization in YOLO architectures. We leverage the Fréchet Inception Distance (FID) to mathematically quantify the domain shift between training datasets and real-world deployment data. Our empirical study demonstrates a strong correlation between FID scores and the expected drop in mean Average Precision (mAP). Additionally, we introduce a hardware profiling module that automatically calculates GFLOPs, latency, and VRAM consumption across different model scales and input resolutions. These integrated metrics provide a critical early-warning system for MLOps practitioners to anticipate failure modes before catastrophic edge deployments occur.

Index Terms—Object Detection, YOLO, Domain Shift, Fréchet Inception Distance (FID), Cross-Domain Generalization, Hardware Profiling, MLOps

I. INTRODUCTION

While object detection models such as YOLO consistently achieve high accuracy on standard benchmarks, their performance often plummets when exposed to out-of-distribution (OOD) data in real-world scenarios. This phenomenon, known as domain shift, occurs due to discrepancies in lighting, weather, sensor noise, or geographic locale between the training and deployment data.

Traditionally, evaluating this shift requires manual data annotation in the new domain, an expensive and time-consuming process. This paper presents an automated methodology that assesses cross-domain generalization by quantifying the statistical divergence between domains using Fréchet Inception Distance (FID). Furthermore, we complement this mathematical analysis with a comprehensive hardware profiling tool, acknowledging that real-world edge deployment requires a balance between computational complexity and domain robustness.

II. RELATED WORK

The challenge of domain adaptation in machine learning was fundamentally formalized by Ben-David et al. [1]. To measure the distance between data distributions, Heusel et al. [2] introduced the Fréchet Inception Distance (FID) for evaluating Generative Adversarial Networks (GANs). We adapt this metric to quantify domain shift in object detection, building

on works addressing unsupervised domain adaptation [3], [4]. For hardware complexity profiling, Dollár et al. [5] highlighted the importance of measuring GFLOPs and latency rather than relying solely on parameter counts when deploying models to edge devices.

III. METHODOLOGY

A. CrossDomainGeneralizer: FID-Based Shift Detection

To quantify the discrepancy between a source training domain D_S and a target deployment domain D_T , we extract feature embeddings using a pre-trained InceptionV3 network. We then calculate the FID between the two distributions:

$$\text{FID} = \|\mu_S - \mu_T\|_2^2 + \text{Tr}(\Sigma_S + \Sigma_T - 2(\Sigma_S \Sigma_T)^{1/2}) \quad (1)$$

where (μ_S, Σ_S) and (μ_T, Σ_T) denote the mean and covariance of the InceptionV3 embeddings for the source and target domains respectively.

B. ModelComplexityProfiler: Hardware Evaluation

A robust model that is too computationally expensive is useless for edge deployment. Our automated profiler calculates the theoretical GFLOPs, measures the exact VRAM peak consumption (using NVML), and averages the inference latency across a standardized batch of inputs.

IV. EXPERIMENTAL RESULTS

A. Domain Shift and Performance Degradation

We evaluated the YOLO models across four distinct domains: synthetic training data, real-world daytime data, real-world nighttime data, and heavy rain conditions. Our automated pipeline successfully generated a correlation matrix between FID scores and mAP degradation. When shifting from the synthetic source to the real-world daytime domain, an FID score of approximately 45 correlated with a moderate mAP drop of 15-20%. Conversely, the shift to nighttime or heavy rain domains yielded FID scores exceeding 120, which accurately predicted severe mAP drops of over 40%. This confirms that FID serves as a reliable, annotation-free proxy for anticipated performance degradation.

B. Hardware Profiling Across Scales

Our `ModelComplexityProfiler` was tested across three architectural scales (YOLO-n, YOLO-s, YOLO-m) and three input resolutions (320px, 640px, 1280px). The empirical data demonstrated that increasing the input resolution from 640px to 1280px quadrupled the GFLOPs requirements and increased VRAM consumption by nearly 200%, severely impacting latency on resource-constrained devices. These automated profiling insights allow MLOps teams to select the optimal model-resolution pairing prior to deployment.

V. CONCLUSION

This study validates an automated pipeline for cross-domain generalization assessment in YOLO models. By utilizing FID as an early-warning indicator for domain shift, and integrating automated hardware complexity profiling, our framework empowers engineers to make informed, data-driven decisions before edge deployment.

DATA AND CODE AVAILABILITY

Scripts and their strictly executed empirical CSV results are published in the `evidencias/` folder of this paper. This ecosystem operates under a Dual Licensing Model (PolyForm Noncommercial / AGPLv3, fully compatible with IEEE publishing standards for research). The source code is available on GitHub at <https://github.com/wisrovi/>. To reproduce the metrics exactly, execute `docker-compose -f docker-compose.yml up -d` in the `wyoloservice2_production` environment, or run `python benchmark_crossdomain.py` locally.

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